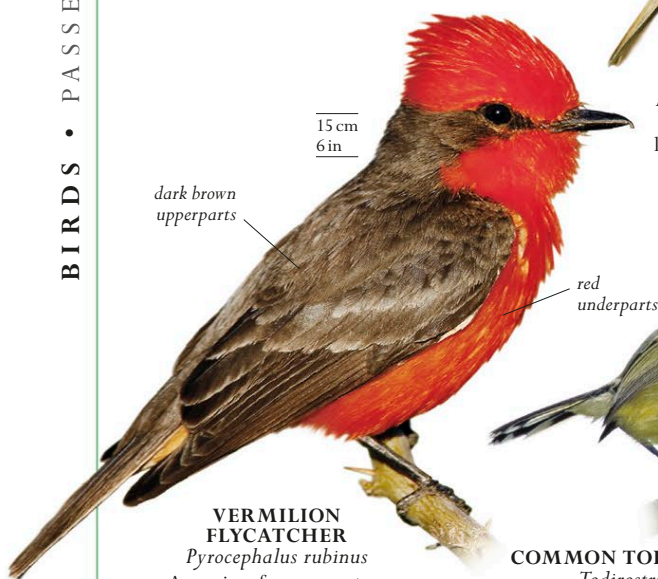


TYRANT FLYCATCHERS AND RELATIVES

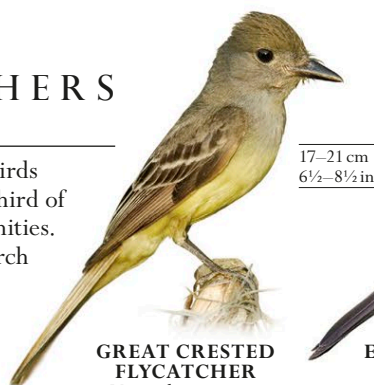
Widespread throughout the Americas, these birds of the family Tyrannidae often account for a third of all passerines in South American bird communities. These birds are insectivorous and typically perch and wait for prey or glean it from foliage.



VERMILION FLYCATCHER

Pyrocephalus rubinus

A species of open country, this bird forages near the ground. Males are vivid red, whereas females are mainly grey and white.



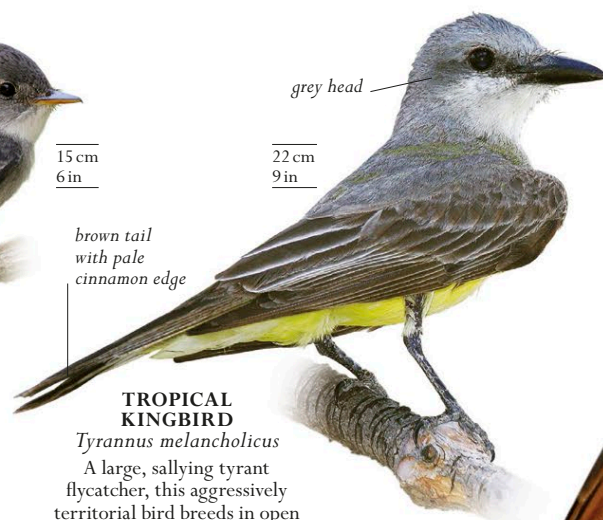
GREAT CRESTED FLYCATCHER
Myiarchus crinitus

A widespread tyrant flycatcher, this large, migratory species, like its relatives, catches insects on the wing. It often hovers when foraging.



EASTERN WOOD PEWEE
Contopus virens

This bird, with its characteristic "pewee" call, hunts by sallying – taking off from perches to catch insects in mid-air. It breeds in eastern N. America.



TROPICAL KINGBIRD

Tyrannus melancholicus

A large, sallying tyrant flycatcher, this aggressively territorial bird breeds in open habitats from southern N. America to S. America.



COMMON TODY-FLYCATCHER
Todirostrum cinereum

This tiny C. and S. American tyrant flycatcher is typical of a group that forages by upward striking, but favours more open habitat than its relatives.



CLIFF FLYCATCHER
Hirundinea ferruginea

This flycatcher from northern and central S. America is swallow-like in its aerial foraging behaviour, and perches on rocky outcrops.

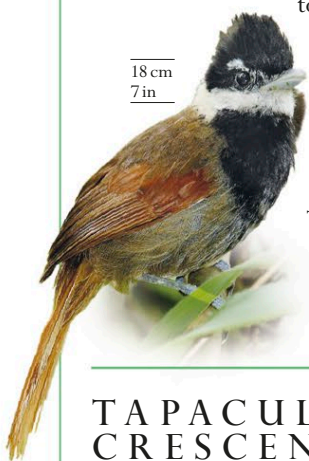


BLACK PHOEBE
Sayornis nigricans

This tail-wagging, tyrant flycatcher forages close to the ground in tropical regions, often near water. It dives into ponds to capture minnows.

TYPICAL ANT BIRDS

From tropical American forests, these heavy-billed birds of the family Thamnophilidae hunt insects near the ground, with some following army ants to feed on insects fleeing the ants. Some are long-clawed for gripping vertical stems.



WHITE-BEARDED ANTSHRIKE

Biatius nigropectus

This little-known, uncommon species is restricted to S.E. Brazil, where it feeds on insects in bamboo forests. It is threatened by deforestation.



MOUSTACHED ANTPITTA
Grallaria alleni

A rare species found in isolated localities in Colombia and Ecuador, the moustached antpitta inhabits undergrowth in humid montane forest.

TAPACULOS AND CRESCENT-CHESTS

Strong-legged and weak-flying, the Rhinocryptidae and Melanopareiidae, are among the most ground adapted of South American passerines. Some have long hind claws to scratch for food in soil and leaf litter.



COLLARED CRESCENT-CHEST
Melanopareia torquata

Crescent-chests have a longer tail than tapaculos and have been separated into a new family, the Melanopareiidae. This Brazilian species occurs in arid habitats.

GNATEATERS

Dumpy, short-tailed, long-legged insect-eaters of forest undergrowth, gnateaters of the family Conopophagidae are secretive birds that forage near the ground using tyrant-like sallying or gleaning techniques. They are related to antbirds.

RUFIOUS GNATEATER
Conopophaga lineata

More abundant than other gnateater species, this bird from eastern S. America often moves in mixed-species flocks and uses degraded habitats.



AUSTRALASIAN WRENS

The Maluridae are small, cock-tailed insect-eaters that resemble wrens of the northern hemisphere, but are more closely related to nectar-feeding honeyeaters. Male fairy-wrens are patterned in blue and black. Emu-wrens and grasswrens are browner birds of grassy habitats.

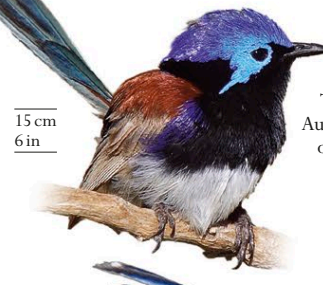
STRIATED GRASSWREN
Amytornis striatus

Like most other grasswrens, this C. Australian species favours spinifex grass, where family groups dart beneath bushes.



VARIEGATED FAIRY-WREN
Malurus lamberti

This most widespread Australian fairy-wren, like others, builds a domed nest. Young may stay close to help raise the next brood.



SPLENDID FAIRY-WREN
Malurus splendens

Fairy-wrens form strong pair bonds, but partners may mate with other individuals. This species is found mostly in southern Australia.

